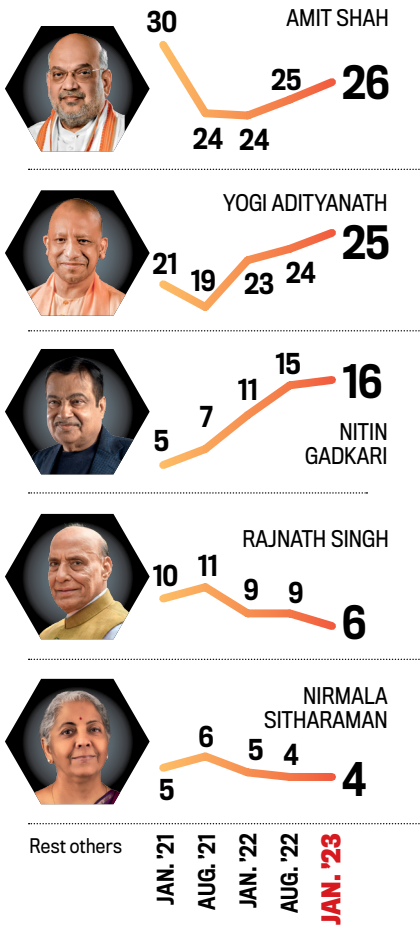
Q WHO IS BEST SUITED TO SUCCEED MODI AS THE PRIME MINISTERIAL CANDIDATE OF THE BJP?





NEXT IN LINE Union home minister Amit Shah and UP CM Yogi Adityanath at an event in Varanasi, Dec. 2022

ANI

captures. For instance, while its handling of Covid-19 still figures as the government's major achievement, this may not win it brownie points a year from now. Likewise with the abrogation of Article 370—interest in it may be waning, except among the Hindutva faithful, unless the Modi government decides to hold an assembly election in Jammu and Kashmir later this year. And now that the BJP has delivered on the promise to build the Ram temple in Ayodhya, it will reap additional dividend only after the new temple is inaugurated just before the polls, as is planned.

The latter two issues may help the BJP retain its core vote banks of around 20 to 25 per cent. But there will be limits to the party's gains from religious polarisation. While many voters may denounce the perceived appeasement policies towards Muslims in the past, they do not want communal polarisation to reach dangerous levels and end up in large-scale confrontations among communities. Ramming through a Uniform Civil Code, despite the widespread support for it, may also prove counterproductive. Elsewhere, the MOTN survey was divided on whether democracy was in danger with 43.2 per cent agreeing and 42.6 per cent saying no. As to whether the BJP government was misusing central enforcement agencies to strike at political opponents, 44.2 per cent agreed while 42.4 per cent said no. MOTN figures also reflect the